Q+A

# STILL SMASHING

*Thirty-eight-year-old squash champion* ***Joshna Chinappa****'s win at the National Doubles Championships shows she's still in fine form*



**Q. You recently won the women's final at the National Doubles Championships alongside Anahat Singh. Do you have a long-term plan with this pairing?**

Anahat and I were casually discussing the doubles and decided to play together. We will be playing the Asian Doubles Championships in Malaysia in June. She is a solid player, so it makes it easier and more fun.

**Q. How have you modified your game with age?**

I have a deep appreciation and respect for my body and what it has done over the past three decades for me to be able to play squash professionally. I definitely have to put in more work in terms of how I prepare for a game with my strength training, fitness, diet, etc.

**Q. You've been playing squash for three decades now. How has the game evolved over the years?**

The game has definitely gotten a lot more intense physically and you have so many different players with amazing skill to add to that physicality. There are so many tournaments happening all around the world and in India.

**Q. What do you make of the next generation of Indian players?**

There are a good crop of young players doing well at the junior and professional level. It's so good to see about 6-7 of them playing the big PSA events consistently. I hope more juniors make the switch to go pro because that's where the real test is.

***—with Shail Desai***